DESAI SETHI
SCHOOL OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP

IDEAS Program Status Update

Early Stage Venture Creation & Pre-Incubation

IDEAS = **I**nnovation, **D**evelopment and **E**ntrepreneurship with **A**lumni **S**upport

August 2026

The IDEAS Program Team



Prof Anu Narasimhan

Professor of Practice

Desai Sethi School of Entrepreneurship

Marketing & Strategy



Dr. Shruti Gupte

Sr. Project Manager – Pre-Incubation Programs

IDEAS Program, WIE

Finance, Leadership and Change Management



Aasiya Chougule

Senior Administrative Assistant

IDEAS Program

Academic Operations, Communication & Program Support

Program Intent

First decade: 800 ventures | 70 startups | **$700M+** fund-raise

First decade: Community with 1,300+ founders | 700 startups | **$8B+** fund-raise



Core Principles

- Structured program enabled by mentors (inspired by **MIT VMS)**
- Scalable program with network effects (inspired by **Stanford StartX)**
- Peer learning among cohort members and alumni founders



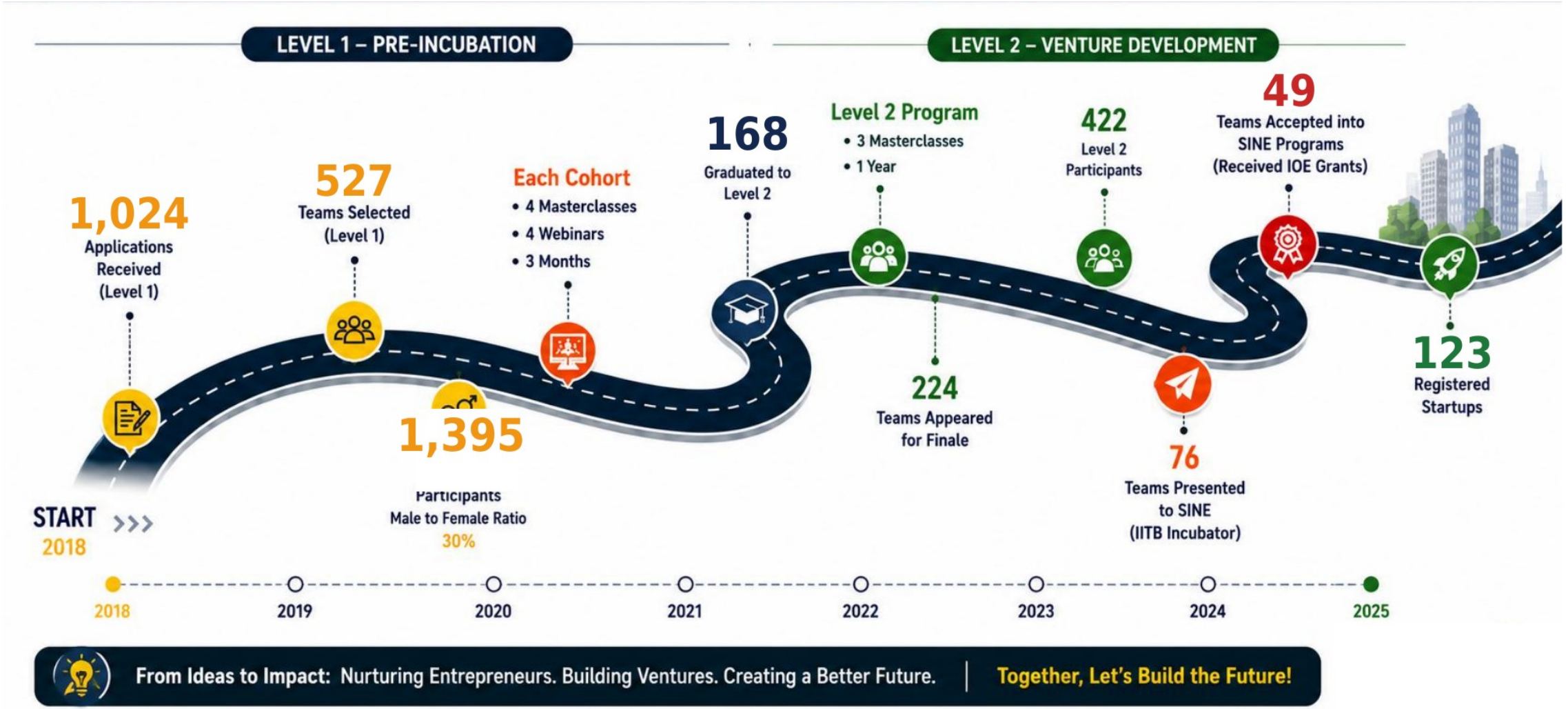
Mentorship-driven Venture Creation Platform

- Democratize venture creation by enabling anyone with passion to get started
- Encourage teams to adopt outside-in thinking and avoid solutions searching for problems
- Active feedback loops with content and timely inputs to provide directional guidance

Early Stage Venture Creation & Pre-Incubation

IDEAS Venture Development Journey

From 1,024 applications to 123 registered ventures · 2018–2025



IITB Entrepreneurship Ecosystem



Structure and Gates

Level 0 → Level 1 → Level 2

★ IDEA Triggers

★ Selection

★ Graduate

★ Demo Day

Level 0
Innovation Triggers

- Idea Generation
- Team Building
- Start-up Clinic / Mentor Hours
- ENT Courses

Level 1
Problem–Solution Fit

- 3-month structured program
  ₹1 Lakh Grant (~$1,053) | 1 Alumni Mentor
- Weekly coaching on Problem–Solution Fit, Customer Persona & Product Concept
- Evidence-based decision to Go, Pivot or No-Go

Level 2
Product–Market Fit

- 12-month structured program
  ₹5 Lakhs Grant (~$5,263) | 2 Alumni Mentors
- Workshops on Technology & NPD, Legal, Finance, Leadership, Sales & Marketing
- Building an MVP and testing for Product–Market Fit

527	190	1,817	100+	123	8
Level 1 Teams	Level 2 Teams	Aspiring Entrepreneurs	Mentors	Registered Startups	Years

** 1 USD ≈ ₹95*

Operationalizing Level 1 Cohort

3-Month Cohort-Based Program

Intensive, structured journey for early-stage venture development.

Focus on Problem–Solution Fit

Helping teams identify, validate and develop solutions for real-world problems.

Fortnightly Masterclasses & Workshops

On topics related to early-stage ventures, by domain experts.

Fortnightly Team Webinars

Teams share progress, get mentor input and receive feedback.

Finale Presentation at End of Cohort

Graduate to Level 2, continue in Level 1, or pivot.

Team Grant of ₹1 Lakh (~USD 1,053)

Early funding support to accelerate execution.





3-Month Cohort-Based Pre-Incubation Program

** 1 USD ≈ ₹95*

Operationalizing Level 2 Cohorts

1-Year Self-Paced Program
Flexible journey over 12 months to build and scale your venture.

Focus on Product–Market Fit
Validating product–market fit and building sustainable businesses.

Prototype & MVP with Business Plan
Build MVPs and develop robust business plans with structured guidance.

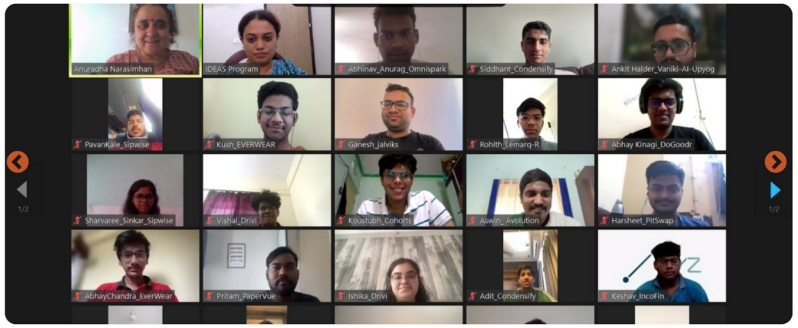
Masterclasses on IP, Finance & Legal
Expert-led sessions to strengthen key foundational areas.

Mentor Support on Production / GTM
One-on-one mentoring to help you build, launch and scale.

Investor Presentations
Pitch to investors and ecosystem partners to accelerate growth.

Team Grant of ₹5 Lakhs (~USD 5,263)
Seed funding to fuel product development and market entry.





1-Year Self-Paced Venture Development Program

190	422	76	49
Teams Selected	Participants	Presented to SINE	Accepted · IOE Grants

** 1 USD ≈ ₹95*

Partnerships

Student Bodies

e-cell
IIT BOMBAY

STAB
Students' Technical Activities Body

INSTITUTION'S INNOVATION COUNCIL
(Ministry of Education Initiative)





Centres of Excellence

BETIC
Biomedical Engineering and Technology Innovation Centre

FedEx ALFA
Center for Advanced Logistics and Focused Analytics

GESH IITB
Green Energy and Sustainability Research Hub

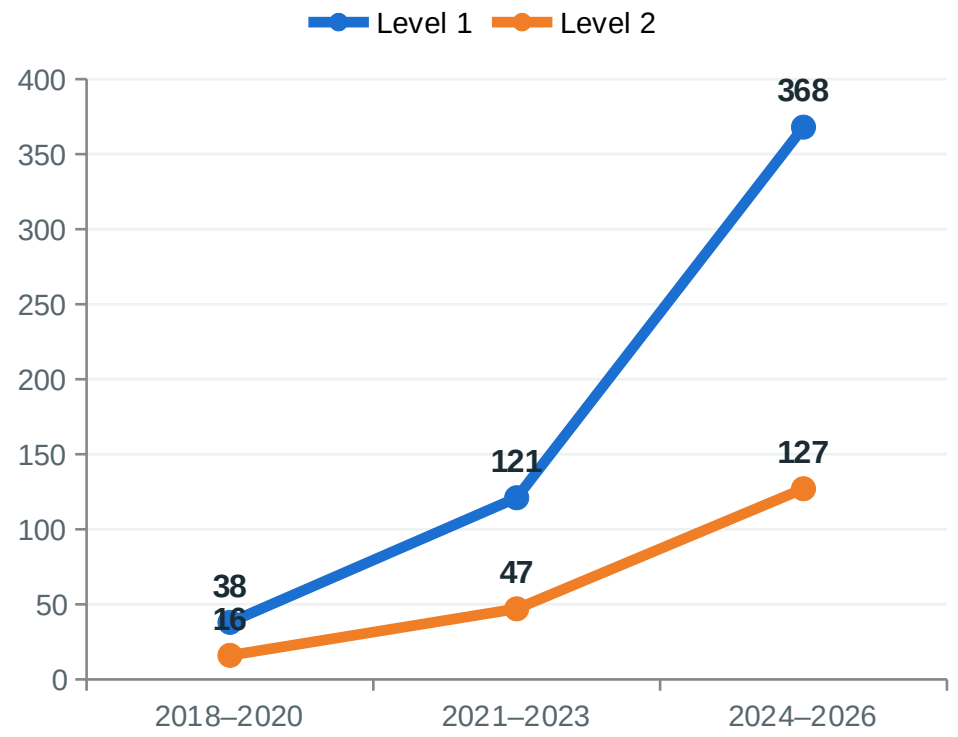
Incubators / Investors

SINE
Business Incubator
IIT Bombay

Outcomes



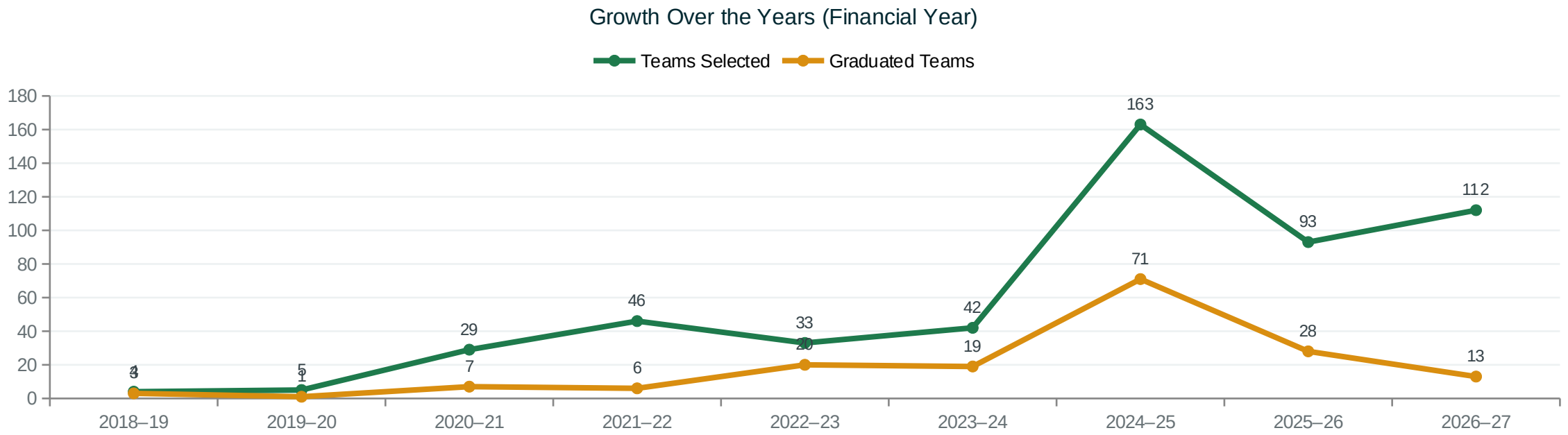
TEAMS PARTICIPATING (ANNUAL)



From IDEAS to Impactful Ventures

Level 1 Cohorts

1,024	527	1,395	168
Applications Received	Teams Selected	Participants in Cohort	Graduated Teams



Applications, Teams and Graduation — 2018 to 2026

Level 2 Cohorts

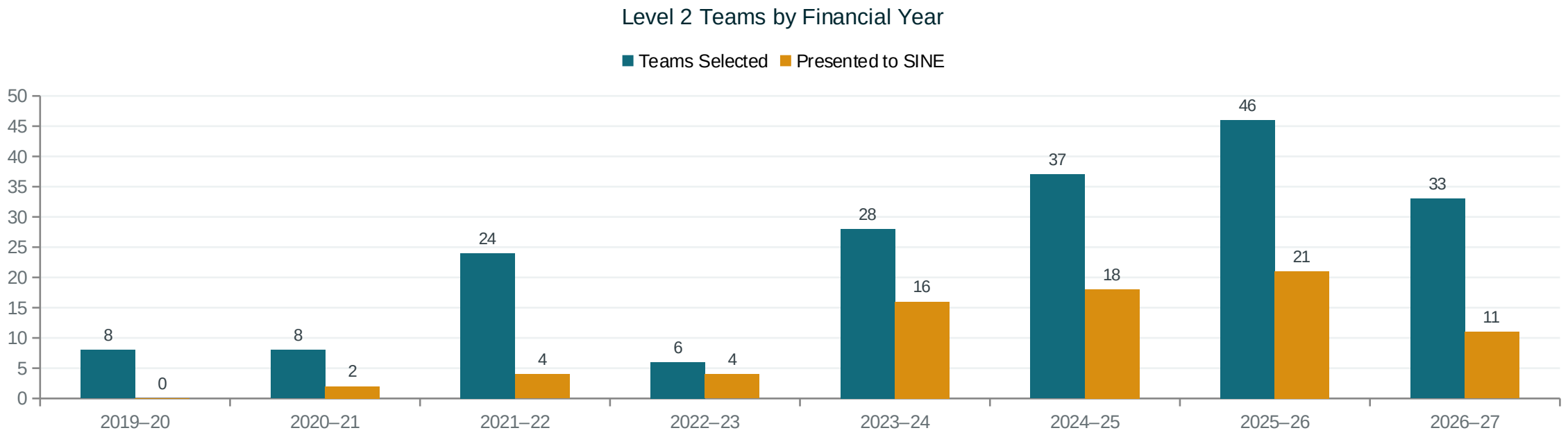
190
Teams Selected

422
Participants

249
Teams Appeared for Finale

76
Teams Presented to SINE

49
Teams Accepted by SINE



Nurturing High-Potential Teams. Creating Impact.

Startups of DSSE Students

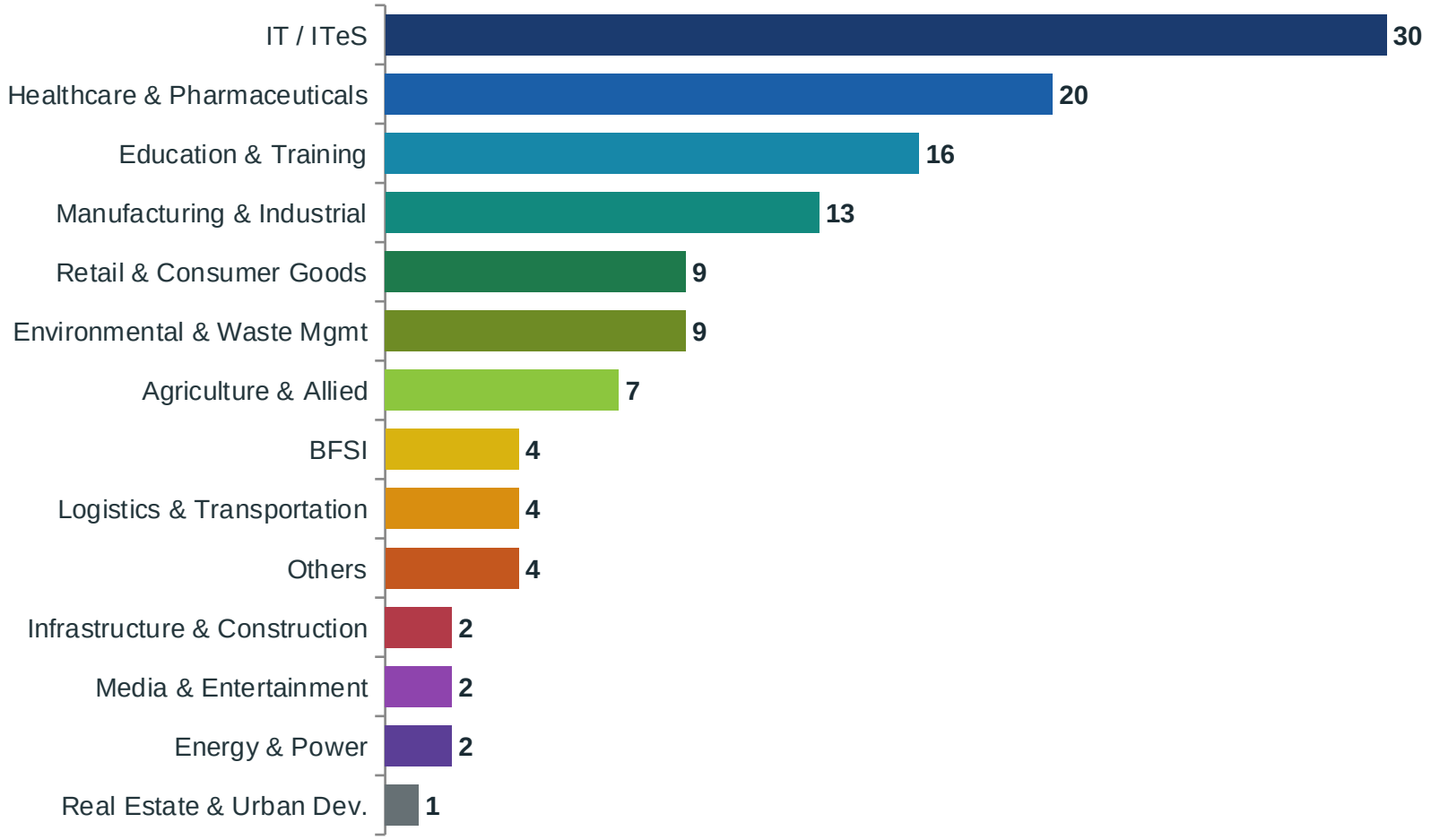
163 Startups by DSSE Students — 123 from the IDEAS Program



Source: Internet

Domains of Venture Teams

123 Registered Ventures across 14 Domains



123
Registered Ventures

14
Domains

₹95 Cr+
Annual Revenue Reported*

₹32 Cr+
Disclosed Funds Raised*

1,000+
Jobs Created*

8
Years of the IDEAS Program

** Aggregated from figures reported by ventures in the Startup Master (13 Jul); many did not disclose — actuals are higher.*

Startup Showcase: GRUH · Novel Hydrogel · Sustain&Co

GRUH

Construction Tech | AI | Commerce

THE PROBLEM

Fragmented material procurement leading to high costs, delays and inefficiencies in the construction industry.



OUR SOLUTION

Tech-enabled platform that simplifies material sourcing for construction professionals with speed, transparency and reliability.



INVESTOR HIGHLIGHTS

- ₹15 Lakhs+ Pilot Transactions
- ₹2.75 Lakhs+ Early Revenue
- Marketplace model with high scalability

GRANT RECEIVED
₹ 5 Lakhs
(DSSE, IIT Bombay)

PILOT TRANSACTIONS
₹ 15 Lakhs+

REVENUE
₹ 2.75 Lakhs+

Novel Hydrogel

HealthTech | Deep Tech

THE PROBLEM

Diabetic wounds heal slowly and are prone to infections, leading to serious complications and amputations.



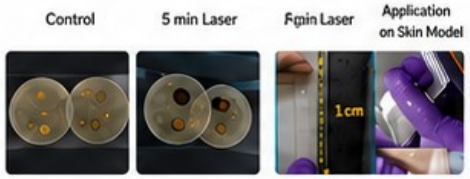
OUR SOLUTION

Photothermal hydrogel patch that converts NIR light to heat, improving blood flow and accelerating wound healing with antimicrobial action.

KEY CUSTOMERS

- Diabetologists
- Endocrinologists
- Foot Surgeons

In-vitro Testing Results



TRL LEVEL
5

STAGE
Preclinical

VALIDATION
In-vitro Testing

FUNDING
₹ 14 Lakhs (Dec 2024)
(SINE to Grant + (DEAS L-2 Grant)

Sustain&Co

ClimateTech | Energy Analytics

THE PROBLEM

Lack of reliable data-driven insights for renewable energy planning and decision-making.

Our Analytics Platform



OUR SOLUTION

AI-powered platform offering data-driven tools for renewable energy site assessment, hybrid planning, and predictive analytics.

CLIMATE INTELLIGENCE DASHBOARD



KEY CUSTOMERS

Government agencies, consultants, energy developers, financial institutions and utility companies.

GRANT RECEIVED
₹ 9 Lakhs (SINE) + ₹ 3 Lakhs
(DSSE, IIT Bombay)

TRL LEVEL
4

CUSTOMERS
Government Agencies, Consultants, Energy Developers, Financial Institutions

PRODUCT
Interactive Dashboard

Source: Internet

Note: ₹ values are approximate and based on an assumed exchange rate of ₹100/USD.

Startup Showcase: Team Conducting Ink Pen · AquaShodh · SEPAL

Team Conducting Ink Pen

EdTech | Industrial Learning

Empowering hands-on STEM learning

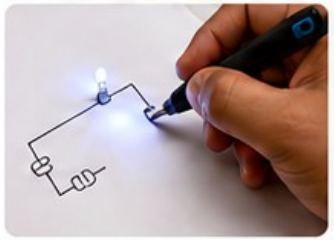
THE PROBLEM

Traditional STEM learning lacks hands-on experience, making it hard for students to understand basic electricity and circuits.



OUR SOLUTION

A conducting ink pen that enables students to draw circuits on paper and create real, working connections safely and easily.



KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Enables learning electricity without wires
- Hands-on STEM tool for schools
- India's first conducting ink pen

TRL LEVEL	FUNDING RAISED (SINE-IOE)	STATUS
9	₹45 Lakhs	Actual system proven through mission operations
System Proven	(June 2024)	

AquaShodh

NanoInvent Technologies

Deep Tech | Water Purification

Arsenic removal at nanoscale

THE PROBLEM

Presence of heavy metal ions like arsenic in water poses a severe threat to health and environment.



OUR SOLUTION

Nanoscale technology for efficient removal of arsenic and heavy metals from contaminated water.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Targets heavy metal contamination (Arsenic)
- Applicable for government labs, industries
- Scalable and cost-effective solution

TRL LEVEL	STAGE	FUNDING
5	Lab Validated	IOE Grant Supported
System Prototype		

SEPAL

Mobility | Auto Accessories

Smart canopy for rider safety

THE PROBLEM

Two-wheeler riders face discomfort and risk due to exposure to sun, rain, dust and cold.



OUR SOLUTION

A collapsible canopy that attaches to motorcycles, protecting riders from harsh weather conditions.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Innovative collapsible canopy for two-wheelers
- IoT-enabled for enhanced riding experience
- Designed and developed in India

RECOGNITION	AWARDS	SUPPORT
Featured on Shark Tank India	Multiple Innovation Awards	Supported by Government Grants

Source: Internet

Note: ₹ values are approximate and based on an assumed exchange rate of ₹100/USD.

Startup Showcase: Indrones · Airth · Amaterasu

Indrones Solutions Pvt Ltd

Domain: DroneTech | Data Analytics

AI-powered drone analytics platform

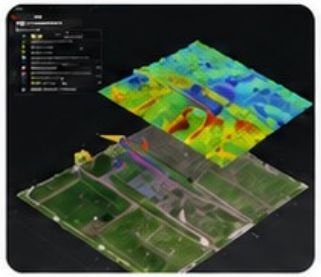
THE PROBLEM

Traditional data collection methods are time-consuming, expensive and lack accuracy.



OUR SOLUTION

- UAV-based data acquisition for enterprises & government
- Custom drone solutions for multiple industries
- High-precision, cost-effective aerial insights



ACHIEVEMENTS & GROWTH

- Government and enterprise deployments
- AI-enabled aerial intelligence solutions
- Scalable drone analytics platform
- Expanding applications across sectors

FUNDING
Grant Supported

STAGE
Commercial Pilots

Airth

Domain: CleanTech | Air Quality

World's First AC-Based Air Purification System

THE PROBLEM

Indoor air pollution caused by dust, allergens, bacteria and harmful gases affects health and productivity.



OUR SOLUTION

- Removes 99% of pollutants, allergens, bacteria & harmful gases
- Works seamlessly with existing AC systems
- Enhances indoor air quality efficiently with low maintenance



INVESTOR HIGHLIGHTS

- Strong product-market relevance
- Scalable B2C + B2B use cases
- Aligned with sustainability goals

TRL LEVEL
7
(System Prototype)

STAGE
Market Deployment

FUNDING
Venture Backed

Amaterasu

Domain: HealthTech | Light Therapy

Artificial Sunlight for Indoor Well-Being

THE PROBLEM

Lack of natural sunlight indoors leads to deficiency of Vitamin D, mood disorders, and reduced productivity.



OUR SOLUTION

- Multi-wavelength lighting system replicating natural sunlight
- Supports mood, focus, Vitamin D & overall well-being
- Safe, energy-efficient and easy to use

- Focus & Mood (Blue)
- Beauty (Red & NIR)
- Vitamin D (UVB)
- Comfort (Far-IR)

MARKET POTENTIAL

- Wellness & Healthcare Applications
- Corporate & Home Segments
- Scalable Global Market Opportunity

RECOGNITION
Featured on Shark Tank India

AWARDS
Multiple Innovation Awards

SUPPORT
Supported by Government Grants

Source: Internet

Note: ₹ values are approximate and based on an assumed exchange rate of ₹100/USD.

Startup Showcase: ScrubStudio · GRADPIPE · MedNest AI

ScrubStudio

Personalized Skincare Tech

Personalized Skincare, Made for You

THE PROBLEM

Generic skincare products don't address individual skin needs, leading to inefficacy and waste.



OUR SOLUTION

- Modular skincare podette with refillable pods
- Dual-use scrub-mask formulations
- Personalized, sustainable and science-backed skincare



KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Personalized skincare solution
- Sustainable & refillable system
- Science-Backed & Dermatologist Approved
- Designed for daily & diverse skin needs

FUNDING Grant Supported

STAGE Product Development

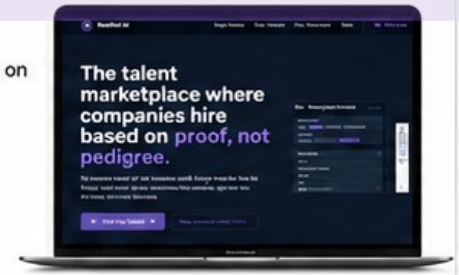
GRADPIPE

Hiring Tech

The Talent Marketplace for Proof, Not Pedigree

THE PROBLEM

Traditional hiring focuses on resumes and degrees, missing real skills and project experience.



OUR SOLUTION

- AI-powered career co-pilot for students
- Personalized career guidance & project matchmaking
- Proof-based talent marketplace for companies
- Discover & engage top 1% of student talent
- Verified projects & skill analytics

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- 1,000+ User Community
- $1,000+ Revenue Generated Within 3 Weeks of MVP Launch
- MVP Product Status
- Verified Projects & Skill Analytics

TRL LEVEL 7 (System Prototype)

STAGE Market Deployment

FUNDING Venture Backed

MedNest AI

HealthTech | AI Diagnostics

Automating Radiology Reporting

THE PROBLEM

Radiologists spend significant time on routine reporting, leading to delays and high workload.



OUR SOLUTION

- AI-powered radiology report dictation
- Converts speech to accurate structured reports
- Saves time and improves reporting accuracy

- Voice to Report
- Structured & Accurate
- Fast & Efficient
- Secure & Compliant

CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

- Tele-radiologists
- Large Hospitals
- Independent Practices
- Diagnostic Centers

TRACTION & IMPACT

- 10+ Active Users
- $10,000 Raised (Dec '24)
- SINE IoE Grant + IDEAS Level 2 Grant

RECOGNITION Featured on Shark Tank India

AWARDS Multiple Innovation Awards

SUPPORT Supported by Government Grants

Source: Internet

Note: ₹ values are approximate and based on an assumed exchange rate of ₹100/USD.

Startup Showcase: SIPWISE · JALVIKS · PAAVAN

SIPWISE

Hydration. Intelligent. Yours.

Domain: HealthTech | Hydration & Wellness

Smart Hydration for a Healthier You



THE PROBLEM

People don't drink enough water daily, leading to poor health, low energy and productivity.

OUR SOLUTION

SIPWISE is a smart hydration bottle with UV-C sterilization, hydration tracking, reminders and insights to build healthy hydration habits.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- UV-C Self-Cleaning Technology for 99.9% germ protection
- Tracks intake & reminds you to stay hydrated
- Insights & goals through companion app
- Designed for individuals and corporate wellness

CUSTOMERS	USE CASES	STATUS	BUSINESS MODEL
Individuals & Corporate Wellness Programs	Daily Health, Fitness, Offices, Travel	Product Live & Market Available	D2C Sales, Corporate Partnerships

JALVIKS

Domain: AgriTech | Climate Intelligence

Climate Intelligence for Resilient Agriculture

THE PROBLEM

Farmers face climate uncertainty, inefficient irrigation and low yields due to lack of real-time, actionable insights.



OUR SOLUTION

Jalviks combines satellite data, on-field sensors and AI to deliver precision irrigation, crop health monitoring and climate risk advisory at the field level.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- High-resolution Satellite, IoT & AI Platform
- Actionable Insights for Irrigation & Crop Management
- Improves Yields, Saves Water & Reduces Risks
- Serving FPOs, Agri Enterprises and Government Programs

CUSTOMERS	IMPACT	STATUS	BUSINESS MODEL
FPOs, Farmers, Agri Enterprises, Govt. Programs	Water Savings, Higher Yields, Climate Resilience	Pilots & Paid Deployments Ongoing	SaaS Platform, Subscriptions, Data Services

PAAVAN

GO ELECTRIC

Domain: Clean Mobility | E-Cycles

Affordable E -Cycles for a Sustainable Tomorrow

THE PROBLEM

Students and last-mile delivery partners need affordable, efficient and eco-friendly mobility options.



OUR SOLUTION

Paavan Go Electric builds smart, durable and affordable electric cycles for students and delivery professionals.

- Up to 50 km Range per Charge
- Cost-effective & Low Maintenance
- Ideal for Campuses & Daily Commute
- Promoting Sustainable Mobility

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Up to 50 km Range per Charge
- Cost-effective, Low Maintenance & Made for India
- Ideal for Campuses, Daily Commute and Deliveries
- Promoting Sustainable & Healthy Mobility

CUSTOMERS	RANGE	STATUS	BUSINESS MODEL
Students, Delivery Partners, Fleet Operators	Up to 50 km per Charge	Product Development & Pilots	Product Sales, B2B Fleet Partnerships

OUR MISSION: Building innovative, scalable and sustainable solutions that create real impact. | **OUR VISION:** Empowering lives and shaping a better, greener future.

Source: Internet

Note: ₹ values are approximate and based on an assumed exchange rate of ₹100/USD.

IDEAS Masterclass & Webinar



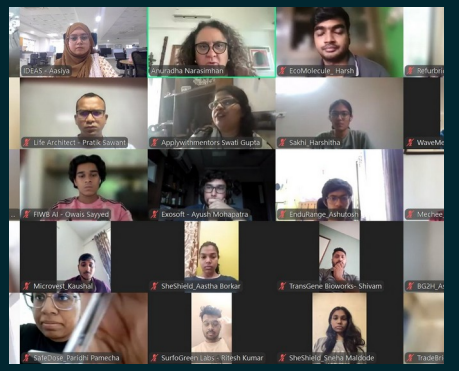














DSSE Building

The home of the IDEAS Program — IIT Bombay





Desai Sethi School of Entrepreneurship · IIT Bombay, Powai

THANK YOU!

We appreciate your time and support.

For collaborations, partnerships and startup engagement, feel free to connect with us.

IDEAS Program
Desai Sethi School of Entrepreneurship
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